The Peacock Throne

When Shah Jahan began his rule, he ordered a magnificent throne. Because it was decorated with peacocks, it became known as the Peacock Throne.

Many Muslims believed peacocks guarded the gateway to Heaven. Because Shah Jahan claimed to speak with the voice of God, his throne was like Heaven. A motto was inscribed on the back of the throne: "If there is a paradise on earth, it is here, it is here."

A cushion rested on a platform eight feet long and six feet wide. Surrounding it were twelve pillars that supported a dome that rose twelve feet above the floor.

No expense was spared in making the throne. The twelve pillars were made of solid gold. In all, more than 2,500 pounds of gold were used to construct the throne. Diamonds, rubies, emeralds, and pearls decorated it inside and out.